Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + carboplatin

Chemotherapy and immunotherapy to help control lung cancer. Your team explains the expected benefits and the choices for you.

Your treatment plan

Treatment is usually on Day 1 of a 21-day cycle: once every 3 weeks. Your team confirms each visit after checking your blood tests and symptoms.

1. **First part: up to 4 cycles**

Pembrolizumab, pemetrexed and carboplatin together. Each cycle lasts 3 weeks.

2. **Review and ongoing treatment**

Carboplatin stops. Pembrolizumab and pemetrexed may continue. Your team reviews how treatment is working and how you are feeling.

Before and between visits

- Take the prescribed folic acid and attend for vitamin B12 injections. These help protect you during pemetrexed treatment.
- Follow your written anti-sickness and steroid plan. Ask the team to check the steroid instructions if you have more than one prescription.
- Have the arranged blood tests and report new symptoms before each visit. Keep your immunotherapy alert card with you.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately for temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions.

Cannot reach the team? Seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Your contact plan

Ask your team to complete these before you leave.

Hospital / team _____

Daytime number and hours _____

Evening / weekend number _____

If unavailable, where to go _____

Keep this with your consent information. Ask your team about anything unclear.

What to watch for

Use the picture and symptom descriptions together. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1. Hormones / brain

Pembrolizumab

Unusual tiredness, dizziness, headache, thirst or passing more urine.

3. Heart

Pembrolizumab

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

5. Kidneys

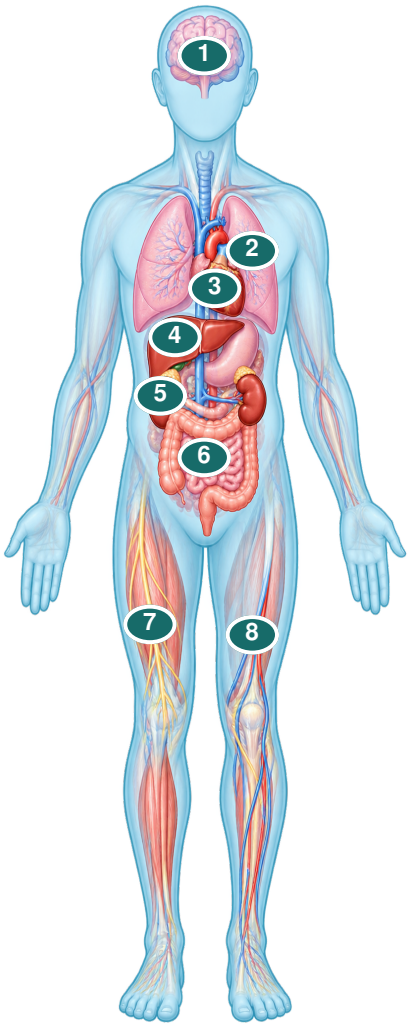
Pemetrexed / pembrolizumab

Kidney function is monitored. Report less urine or new swelling.

7. Skin / nerves

Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy

Spreading rash, blisters, weakness or new numbness should be reported.



2. Lungs

Pembrolizumab

New cough or breathlessness: report promptly. Infection, cancer or a clot can cause similar symptoms.

4. Liver

Pembrolizumab

Yellow eyes or skin, dark urine or changes in blood tests.

6. Bowel

Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy

New diarrhoea, persistent vomiting or severe tummy pain: contact your team.

8. Blood / infection

Pemetrexed / carboplatin

Fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell: contact oncology immediately.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Match each number to its symptom box. Blood, skin and nerve markers are schematic.

Contact the oncology team promptly for fever or feeling acutely unwell, new breathlessness or cough, severe diarrhoea, dehydration, chest pain, confusion, severe rash or other new symptoms. Use the emergency contact instructions given by your team.

My SACT card

Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + carboplatin
Usually Day 1, every 3 weeks. Carboplatin stops after up to 4 cycles.

Includes immunotherapy: new symptoms can occur during treatment or after it ends. Tell any clinician you receive pembrolizumab.

Name: _____
Hospital: _____
Oncology phone: _____
Out of hours: _____

Show this card when seeking care. It does not replace a medicine-specific alert card.

More information, when you want it

Scan for medicines, tests, daily life and your treatment record.

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00568/

SACTCheck · v0.84.28 · Source: NCCP 00568 v5. Feasibility build: independent clinical and patient review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.